on No:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

B325

Managing across organizational and cultural boundaries

Mid-term Exam Makeup /Version A

2024-2025 / Spring

24-April-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 10 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
This Mid-term exam will be marked out of 100 marks and is worth 30% of the total mark of B325 course
Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches.
Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination.
Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
Any work crossed through will **NOT** be marked.
Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY

Question No.	Mark	Marker's Signature
Q1		
Q2		

mments (FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY):

Total: ____ / 100

Final Mark:

SECTION ONE (50 MARKS)

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*You should attempt **ALL** questions in this section.*

Case Study: Diverse Teams at Nexus Corp

Nexus Corp is a multinational corporation based in the United Kingdom that recently established a regional office in Saudi Arabia. The company's corporate culture values high individualism, low power distance, and innovation-driven leadership. However, Nexus Corp is facing challenges with its diverse workforce in Saudi Arabia, where cultural norms emphasize high power distance, collectivism, and respect for hierarchy. Employees report difficulties with communication, leadership expectations, and collaborative decision-making.

Hofstede's Dimensions Table:

Dimension	Nexus Corp (UK)	Saudi Arabia
Power Distance	Low (35)	High (90)
Individualism	High (89)	Low (25)
Uncertainty Avoidance	Moderate (50)	High (70)
Masculinity	High (70)	Moderate (50)
Long-Term Orientation	Moderate (50)	High (60)

Q1a. (20 Marks):
Analyze the cultural differences between Nexus Corp and Saudi Arabia using the data provided in the table above. Highlight key areas of potential conflict.

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Q1b. (15 Marks):
Discuss how these cultural differences, as shown in the table, could impact leadership, employee motivation, and communication at Nexus Corp's Saudi Arabia office.

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Q1c. (15 Marks):
Based on your analysis, recommend strategies for Nexus Corp to bridge these cultural differences and improve team cohesion. Use the data provided to support your recommendations.

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Identification of key areas of potential conflict	10 Marks	
Discussion of leadership, motivation, and communication impacts	15 Marks (5 marks each)	
Recommendations to bridge cultural differences and improve cohesion	15 Marks	
Total:	**50 Marks**	

Section 2 Question: (50 Marks)

Q2. Discuss the importance of cross-cultural competence in managing diverse teams. Use examples to illustrate how managers can overcome cultural biases and stereotypes. What strategies can organizations implement to foster inclusion and improve cross-cultural team dynamics?

FOUGHT

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